

LAUGH / LAUGHTER

1. Passage anchor

> “...different classmates had to decide whether to **laugh along**, remain silent or speak up.”

Passage meaning

laugh along = join other people in laughing, especially because they are already laughing at something or someone

跟著一起笑；附和著笑

Here, the classmates must decide whether to join in when others are laughing at or excluding the new student.

The phrase therefore carries an important social implication:

> **laugh along**

> → not necessarily start the mockery, but **join it**

Practice

1. Some students **laughed along** even though they knew the joke was cruel.

有些學生明知那個笑話很刻薄，仍然**跟著一起笑**。

2. She refused to **laugh along** when the others made fun of him.

其他人取笑他時，她拒絕**跟著附和地笑**。

Core meanings of LAUGH

2. laugh — make sounds because something is funny

As a verb:

= make the characteristic sounds and facial expressions associated with amusement, happiness, etc.

笑；發笑

Examples

1. Everyone **laughed** at the joke.

大家聽到那個笑話都**笑了**。

2. She started **laughing** when she saw his expression.

她看到他的表情後開始**笑**。

This is the central everyday sense.

3. laugh with amusement / joy

= laugh because something is funny, enjoyable, or delightful

因好笑 / 開心而笑

Examples

1. The children **laughed with delight**.

孩子們開心得**笑了起來**。

2. We spent the evening talking and **laughing**.

我們整晚聊天、**歡笑**。

LAUGH AT

4. laugh at something — find something funny

= laugh because something is amusing

因某事好笑而笑

Examples

1. We **laughed at the comedy**.

我們看那齣喜劇時**笑個不停**。

2. She **laughed at his joke**.

她因他的笑話而**笑了**。

This can be harmless.

5. laugh at someone — ridicule

= laugh at a person in a way that makes them feel foolish, embarrassed, or inferior

嘲笑 ; 取笑

Examples

1. The other students **laughed at him**.

其他學生**嘲笑他**。

2. Never **laugh at someone** for making a mistake.

不要因別人犯錯而**取笑對方**。

This sense is especially relevant to the passage.

Laugh with vs laugh at

6. laugh with someone

= share laughter together in a friendly or mutual way

和某人一起笑

Examples

1. We were **laughing with each other**, not at each other.

我們是在**一起笑**，不是互相嘲笑。

2. She likes people she can **laugh with**.

她喜歡能和自己**一起說笑**的人。

7. laugh at vs laugh with

Very important learner distinction:

> **laugh at someone**

> → **嘲笑某人**

but:

> **laugh with someone**

> → **和某人一起笑**

Compare:

> They laughed **at** him.

> 他們**取笑他**。

> They laughed **with** him.

> 他們**和他一起笑**。

One preposition changes the social meaning dramatically.

LAUGH ALONG

8. laugh along

= join other people in laughing

跟著一起笑；附和地笑

This is the exact passage construction.

Examples

1. He did not understand the joke but **laughed along** anyway.

他雖然不明白笑話，但還是**跟著笑**。

2. Everyone else was mocking her, and several students **laughed along**.

其他人正在取笑她，幾名學生也**跟著附和地笑**。

Noun: a laugh

9. laugh — act or sound of laughing

As a noun:

= sound or act of laughing

笑聲；笑

Examples

1. I heard a loud **laugh** behind me.

我聽到身後傳來一聲很大的**笑聲**。

2. Her **laugh** is very distinctive.

她的**笑聲**很有辨識度。

10. have a laugh

= laugh and enjoy oneself, often socially

****開心說笑；玩得開心****

Examples

1. We always ****have a laugh**** together.

我們在一起總是會****開心說笑****。

2. The trip gave everyone a chance to ****have a laugh****.

這趟旅程讓大家有機會****輕鬆開心一下****。

Especially common in BrE.

A laugh = amusing person/thing

11. a laugh — amusing person or experience

Informal:

= person, event, or activity that is enjoyable or funny

****有趣的人 / 事；好玩的經歷****

Examples

1. He's ****a good laugh****.

他是個****很有趣、很好相處的人****。

2. The party was ****a laugh****.

那場派對****挺好玩的****。

Especially common in BrE.

12. a good laugh

= enjoyable person or amusing experience; also a satisfying period of laughter

****有趣的人 / 事；開懷大笑****

Examples

1. She is ****a good laugh****.

她是個****很有趣的人****。

2. We had ****a good laugh**** about the mistake later.

後來我們想到那個錯誤都****大笑了一場****。

Context determines the exact meaning.

For amusement

13. for a laugh

= for fun or amusement, not seriously

****為了好玩；鬧著玩****

Examples

1. He entered the competition ****for a laugh****.

他參加比賽只是****為了好玩****。

2. They made the video ****for a laugh****.

他們拍那段影片只是****鬧著玩****。

Burst out laughing

14. burst out laughing

= suddenly begin laughing

****突然大笑起來****

Examples

1. She ****burst out laughing****.

她突然****大笑起來****。

2. Everyone ****burst out laughing**** when he told the story.

他講完故事後，大家都****突然笑了起來****。

Very high-value construction.

Laugh loudly / intensely

15. laugh one's head off

Informal:

= laugh extremely hard

笑個不停；笑得非常厲害

Examples

1. We **laughed our heads off**.

我們**笑個不停**。

2. She was **laughing her head off** at the video.

她看那段影片時**笑得不得了**。

16. laugh until one cries

= laugh so much that tears appear

笑到流眼淚

Examples

1. We **laughed until we cried**.

我們**笑到流眼淚**。

2. The story had me **laughing until I cried**.

那個故事令我**笑出眼淚**。

LAUGH OFF

17. laugh something off

= treat something embarrassing, worrying, critical, or serious as unimportant by laughing or joking about it

一笑置之；笑著帶過

Examples

1. He **laughed off the criticism**.

他對那些批評**一笑置之**。

2. She tried to **laugh off the embarrassing mistake**.

她試圖把那個尷尬錯誤**笑著帶過**。

Very high-value figurative phrasal verb.

Laugh away

18. laugh something away

= make a worry, awkwardness, fear, etc. seem less serious through laughter

用笑聲化解；笑著消除

Examples

1. They **laughed away the tension**.

他們用笑聲**化解了緊張氣氛**。

2. She tried to **laugh away her embarrassment**.

她試圖用笑聲**掩飾 / 化解尷尬**。

Useful but less common than **laugh off**.

Laugh in someone's face

19. laugh in someone's face

= laugh openly at someone in a disrespectful, defiant, or contemptuous way

當面嘲笑某人；當面嗤笑

Examples

1. They **laughed in his face** when he suggested the idea.

他提出那個想法時，他們竟然**當面嘲笑他**。

2. She refused to let them **laugh in her face**.

她不容許他們**當面羞辱嘲笑她**。

Have the last laugh

20. have the last laugh

= eventually succeed or be proved right after others mocked, doubted, or opposed you

****笑到最後；最終證明自己是對的****

Examples

1. People doubted her, but she ****had the last laugh****.
大家曾經質疑她，但最後是她****笑到最後****。
2. The small company eventually ****had the last laugh****.
那家小公司最終****證明了自己才是贏家****。

Very high-value idiom.

No laughing matter

21. no laughing matter

= serious situation that should not be treated as a joke
****不是開玩笑的事；是很嚴重的事****

Examples

1. Bullying is ****no laughing matter****.
欺凌****絕不是開玩笑的事****。
2. Losing people's private data is ****no laughing matter****.
遺失他人的私人資料是****很嚴重的事情****。

Especially relevant to this passage's theme.

Laughing matter

22. laughing matter

Usually occurs negatively:

> ****no laughing matter****

A ****laughing matter**** means something suitable to joke/laugh about, but the positive form is much less common.

So for learner purposes, prioritize:

****no laughing matter****

→ ****不能當作笑話看的嚴重事情****

Laughing stock

23. laughing stock / laughingstock

= person, group, or thing that many people ridicule

****笑柄；嘲笑對象****

Examples

1. He feared becoming the ****laughing stock**** of the class.

他怕自己成為全班的****笑柄****。

2. The failed campaign made the company a ****laughingstock****.

失敗的宣傳活動令公司成為****眾人的笑柄****。

Very high-value lexicalized expression.

Laugh all the way to the bank

24. laugh all the way to the bank

= make a lot of money from something, especially despite criticism or ridicule

****賺得盆滿鉢滿；儘管被批評仍賺大錢****

Examples

1. Critics hated the film, but the producers ****laughed all the way to the bank****.

批評者很討厭那部電影，但製作人卻****賺得盆滿鉢滿****。

2. People mocked the idea at first, but she ended up ****laughing all the way to the bank****.

大家起初取笑這個想法，但她最後卻****賺了大錢****。

Informal idiom.

Laugh on the other side of one's face

25. laugh on the other side of one's face

Especially BrE, somewhat old-fashioned:

= stop being pleased or confident when circumstances turn against you

****很快就笑不出來；由得意變失意****

Example

1. He may be laughing now, but he'll ****laugh on the other side of his face**** when the results arrive.
他現在可能很得意，但結果公布時恐怕就****笑不出來了****。

Lower priority.

LAUGHTER

26. laughter

= sound or act of people laughing

****笑聲；笑****

Examples

1. The room filled with ****laughter****.
房間裡充滿了****笑聲****。
2. We could hear children's ****laughter**** outside.
我們聽到外面孩子們的****笑聲****。

Important family noun.

27. burst of laughter

= sudden short period of laughter

****一陣笑聲****

Examples

1. A ****burst of laughter**** came from the classroom.
課室裡傳來****一陣笑聲****。
2. His comment caused a ****burst of laughter****.
他的話引起了****一陣笑聲****。

28. roar of laughter

= very loud collective laughter

哄堂大笑；一陣大笑

Examples

1. The joke produced a **roar of laughter**.

那個笑話引起一陣**哄堂大笑**。

2. A **roar of laughter** filled the hall.

大廳裡響起一陣**大笑聲**。

LAUGHING

29. laughing — actively laughing

= showing or producing laughter

正在笑的；帶笑的

Examples

1. A group of **laughing children** ran past.

一群**笑著的孩子**跑過。

2. She looked at him with **laughing eyes**.

她用一雙**帶著笑意的眼睛**看著他。

LAUGHABLE

30. laughable

= so foolish, bad, unreasonable, or inadequate that it deserves ridicule

可笑的；荒謬的

Examples

1. The excuse was **laughable**.

那個藉口十分**可笑**。

2. The amount they offered was **laughable**.

他們提出的數目簡直**荒謬得可笑**。

Often negative, not simply “funny.”

31. laughably

= in a ridiculously inadequate, foolish, or unreasonable way

可笑地；**荒謬地**

Examples

1. The estimate was **laughably low**.

那個估算**低得可笑**。

2. The security was **laughably weak**.

那套保安措施**薄弱得荒謬**。

Laughing gas

32. laughing gas

= informal name for nitrous oxide, used medically for sedation/pain relief and recreationally in some contexts

笑氣；**一氧化二氮**

Examples

1. The dentist used **laughing gas** to help the patient relax.

牙醫使用**笑氣**幫助病人放鬆。

2. **Laughing gas** is the informal name for nitrous oxide.

笑氣是一氧化二氮的俗稱。

Lexicalized compound; meaning is not literally “gas that laughs.”

Laugh track

33. laugh track

= recorded audience laughter added to a television comedy or similar production

****罐頭笑聲；預錄笑聲****

Examples

1. The show uses a ****laugh track****.

那個節目使用****罐頭笑聲****。

2. Some viewers dislike sitcoms with a ****laugh track****.

有些觀眾不喜歡加入****預錄笑聲****的處境喜劇。

Useful media term.

Laugh lines

34. laugh lines

= small wrinkles around the eyes or mouth associated with smiling/laughing

****笑紋；笑紋皺紋****

Examples

1. She had warm ****laugh lines**** around her eyes.

她眼角有親切的****笑紋****。

2. His ****laugh lines**** became more noticeable with age.

隨著年齡增長，他的****笑紋****變得更明顯。

Key contrasts

35. laugh vs smile

****smile****

= form a pleased/friendly expression with the mouth, usually without sound

****微笑****

****laugh****

= produce characteristic sounds/movements because of amusement

****笑出聲；大笑****

Compare:

> She smiled at him.

> 她向他微笑。

> She laughed at the joke.

> 她聽到笑話笑了。

36. laugh vs giggle

****giggle****

= laugh repeatedly in a light, often nervous, embarrassed, or childish way

****咯咯笑；傻笑****

****laugh****

= broad neutral word

****笑****

37. laugh vs chuckle

****chuckle****

= laugh quietly and softly

****輕聲笑；低聲發笑****

****laugh****

= broader and may be loud or quiet.

38. laugh vs grin

****grin****

= smile very broadly, usually showing teeth

****咧嘴笑****

A person may ****grin without laughing****.

39. laugh vs mock

****laugh****

= produce laughter; can be friendly, neutral, joyful, nervous, or cruel

****笑****

****mock****

= deliberately ridicule or make someone look foolish

****嘲笑；嘲弄****

Compare:

> They laughed together.

> 他們一起笑。

> They mocked him.

> 他們嘲笑他。

But:

> ****laugh at someone****

can itself become ridicule.

40. laugh at vs make fun of

****laugh at****

= laugh because of someone, often making them feel foolish

****嘲笑****

****make fun of****

= deliberately joke about or ridicule someone

****取笑****

There is strong overlap in negative social contexts.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****laugh**** is:

****express amusement through characteristic facial movements and sounds****

From this develop several major branches.

A. Ordinary amusement

Joke

laugh at a joke

→ **因笑話而笑**

Socially

laugh with friends

→ **和朋友一起笑**

B. Ridicule

Person

laugh at someone

→ **嘲笑某人**

Passage

laugh along

→ **跟著別人一起笑 / 附和嘲笑**

Target

laughing stock

→ **笑柄**

This distinction matters strongly in the passage.

C. Treat lightly

Criticism

laugh something off

→ **一笑置之**

Tension

laugh something away

→ **用笑聲化解**

D. Enjoyment

Have a laugh

→ **開心說笑**

For a laugh

→ **為了好玩**

E. Idiomatic result

Have the last laugh

→ **笑到最後**

No laughing matter

→ **不是可以拿來開玩笑的事**

Laugh all the way to the bank

→ **儘管被批評仍賺大錢**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
laugh — amusement	因好笑、開心等而發出笑聲；笑
laugh at something	因某件事有趣 / 好笑而笑
laugh at someone	因某人而發笑並使其難堪；嘲笑 / 取笑
laugh with someone	與某人共同歡笑，而不是嘲笑對方
laugh along	別人在笑時也跟著一起笑 / 附和地笑
laugh — noun sound/action	一聲 / 一陣笑；笑聲
have a laugh	開心說笑、一起享受輕鬆時光
a good laugh — person	非正式：有趣、令人開心的人
a good laugh — event	好玩 / 令人開心的經歷；亦可指開懷大笑
for a laugh	只是為了好玩、娛樂，不是認真地
burst out laughing	突然開始大笑
laugh one's head off	非正式：笑得非常厲害 / 笑個不停
laugh until one cries	笑到流眼淚

laugh something off	用笑或玩笑把尷尬、批評、問題等一笑置之	
laugh something away	用笑聲減輕 / 化解尷尬、緊張等	
laugh in someone's face	公然、無禮地當面嘲笑某人	
have the last laugh	曾被取笑 / 質疑後最終成功或證明自己是對的	
no laughing matter	非常嚴重，不能當笑話看的事情	
laughing stock / laughingstock	被很多人嘲笑的人 / 事；笑柄	
laugh all the way to the bank	儘管被批評或取笑仍從中賺到很多錢	
laughter	人們笑時產生的笑聲 / 歡笑	
burst of laughter	突然出現的一陣笑聲	
roar of laughter	非常響亮的一陣大笑 / 哄堂大笑	
laughing — adjective	正在笑的；帶笑意的	
laughable	荒謬、糟糕或不合理到令人發笑的；可笑的	
laughably	荒謬 / 糟糕得可笑地	
laughing gas	一氧化二氮；笑氣	
laugh track	電視喜劇等加入的預錄 / 罐頭笑聲	
laugh lines	因經常笑而在眼角、嘴邊形成的笑紋	

Passage recap

> “...different classmates had to decide whether to **laugh along**, remain silent or speak up.”

Here:

****laugh along**** = ****to join other people in laughing rather than resisting or staying apart****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****跟著一起笑****

* ****附和著笑****

* in this context: ****跟著一起嘲笑****

Natural contextual translation:

****不同的同學必須決定，是要跟著一起嘲笑、保持沉默，還是挺身發聲。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****laugh along****

= ****to join in when other people are laughing****

****跟著一起笑；附和地笑****

The most important learner distinction is:

> **laugh with someone**

> → **和某人一起笑**

but:

> **laugh at someone**

> → **嘲笑某人**

And the passage sits between those two:

> **laugh along**

> → **看到其他人在笑，自己也加入**

Because the surrounding scenario involves exclusion and cruelty, the contextual implication is:

****跟著其他同學一起嘲笑受害者****

Other major branches are:

> **laugh something off**

> → **一笑置之**

> **have the last laugh**

> → **笑到最後**

> **no laughing matter**

> → **不是可以當玩笑看的事**

> **laughing stock**

> → **笑柄**

> **for a laugh**

> → **為了好玩**

So in the passage, **laugh** is not merely a happy emotional reaction. It becomes a **social action**: joining other people's laughter can signal participation in ridicule and exclusion.